CHAPTER

11

Communicable Diseases

உற்றான் அளவும் பிணியளவும் காலமும்
கற்றான் கருதிச் செயல்.

The learned (physician) should ascertain the condition of his patient; the nature of his disease, and the season (of the year) and (then) proceed (with his treatment).

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of the lesson students will be able to

- define technical jargons related to communicable disease
- list out the classification of communicable disease
- identify the clinical manifestation of communicable disease
- understands the complications and control measures of communicable disease

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Introduction

Infections due to living organisms are called communicable diseases. They spread from person to person, or sometimes from animals to people. They occur at all ages but are most serious in childhood and they are preventable to a great extent. In developed countries, communicable diseases have been prevented. But in India it is going through a period of transition, both epidemiological and demographically. Infectious diseases are still persisting as major health problems in spite of having National programmes for the control of many diseases.

11.1 Terminology

1. **Infection:** The entry and development or multiplication of an infectious agent in the body of human being or animals.
2. **Contamination:** The presence of infectious agent on a body surface or in clothes, beddings, toys, surgical instruments or dressings or other inanimate articles or substances including water, milk and food.
3. **Infestation:** For persons or animals the lodgment, development and reproduction of arthropods on the surface of the body or in the clothing (e.g) lice, itch mite.

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